

THE REEL, TAKEN APART.

A frame-by-frame teardown of naira-ugc-final, a hook library built for this catalogue, and the full production plan for the voiceover reel that replaces it.

5.4

CURRENT REEL
/ 10

7.6

AFTER RE-EDIT
NO RESHOOT

9.4

VO REEL
CEILING

23

DEFECTS
LOGGED

Subject af12f0f3-naira-ugc-final-1.10x-split.mp4 · 33.40s · 1080×1920 · 30fps · h264 · AAC 48kHz
Measured 16 shots · 88 spoken words · -13.4 LUFS · -1.0 dBTP · zero music · 2.9s of digital silence
Products Cushion Halo Ring ₹1,199 · Woven Gold Hoops ₹1,799 · Prism Rivière Bracelet ₹2,499
Prepared 17 September 2026

IT IS A 5 WITH AN 8 HIDING INSIDE IT

Your instinct was right. This is a five. But it is not a five because the thinking is bad — the thinking is the best part of it. It is a five because almost every point of loss is mechanical, and mechanical things are cheap to fix.

I pulled the file apart: every cut, every caption position, every shot's colour, the loudness envelope, the silence map, and the live catalogue behind it. Twenty-three defects. Three of them are strategic. Twenty are craft. **Sixteen of the twenty can be fixed in a re-edit of the footage you already have**, without Riya, without a reshoot, in about four hours.

The script has a real voice — “*that’s honestly a crime*”, “*you’re welcome, but keep it between us*” — and most brand UGC has none. More importantly it names craft: *four-claw setting, every single stone in its own halo, brilliant-cut zircon*. Your own competitor audit found that in 498 live creatives across six Indian brands, **nobody in this category argues craft**. This script does. That is the one thing here that cannot be bought, and it is already in the writing.

What it does not do is make you look at the craft. The line says *four-claw setting* and the picture is a ring held at arm’s length, about forty pixels wide, out of focus. That gap — between what the voice claims and what the frame proves — is the whole distance between a 5 and a 9.

THE SINGLE MOST EXPENSIVE THING IN THE FILE

The hero of this reel is the **Cushion Halo Ring at ₹1,199**. That number never appears — not spoken, not on screen, not once in thirty-three seconds. Instead the hook anchors at “**under 2500**”, which is the price of the *most expensive* of the three pieces. You have voluntarily doubled your own price inside the viewer’s head in the first three seconds, and then spent the remaining thirty trying to earn it back.

The four things that cost the most, in order

#	DEFECT	WHY IT COSTS	FIX COST
1	Hook is 3.9s long; picture holds 4.57s	The payload word lands at 2.4s. Nothing on screen changes for four and a half seconds in a format where the average person decides in under two.	Re-edit
2	Anchored at ₹2,500, hero is ₹1,199	The most persuasive number you own is withheld for the least persuasive one. Price-led hook, no price ever on screen.	Rewrite
3	Captions sit at 21% bottom clearance	Meta’s Reels guidance is 35%. Your own BRAND.md says 40%. Every caption in this ad is partly under Instagram’s username block and the Shop Now button.	30 min
4	No music, no foley, 2.9s of digital silence	Literally zero samples at the tail. A jewellery ad with a box opening, a clasp and a tennis bracelet articulating, and not one sound in it.	1 hour

KEEP THESE — THEY ARE THE ASSET

The henna. It is all over the hands in every product shot. It is festive, unmistakably Indian, and a competitor pulling from the same Yiwu factory cannot copy it. Your BRAND.md calls this territory four, “on Indian skin”. You shot it by accident and it is the most ownable frame in the file.

The bracelet macros at 19.7–23.1s. Close, honest, on skin, in focus. This is the only footage in the reel that behaves like

a jewellery ad. It gets 1.27 seconds. The two least interesting shots get 4.6.

The product name cards. Beautifully drawn objects — sage eyebrow, Velista display, the carnation mark. Placed wrongly, but drawn correctly.

FORENSIC SPEC

Everything below is measured from the file, not estimated. Where a number contradicts an impression, trust the number.

CONTAINER & PICTURE		SOUND	
DURATION	33.40 s	INTEGRATED	-13.4 LUFS
RESOLUTION	1080 × 1920 · 9:16	TRUE PEAK	-1.0 dBTP
FRAME RATE	30.00 fps CFR	LOUDNESS RANGE	7.0 LU
CODEC	h264 High · 5,510 kb/s	MUSIC BED	none – 0 tracks
COLOUR	yuv420p · bt709	FOLEY / ASMR	none
SHOTS	16	TAIL 30.5–33.4s	-inf dB (true zero)
MEAN SHOT	2.09 s	INTER-PHRASE GAPS	-47 dB RMS (mic noise)
MEDIAN SHOT	1.97 s	SPOKEN WORDS	88
CUT RATE	0.48 cuts / sec	SPEECH WINDOW	0.00 – 30.16 s
LONGEST SHOT	4.60 s (the ring)	DELIVERY RATE	~175 wpm
SPEED RAMP	1.10× (per filename)	VOICE RECORDING	clean, dry, no room

The cut map

00.00		4.57s
04.57		2.63s
07.20		1.97s
09.17		4.60s
13.77		1.30s
15.07		1.33s
16.40		1.10s
17.50		0.97s
18.47		1.23s
19.70		2.10s
21.80		1.27s
23.07		1.30s
24.37		1.36s
25.73		2.37s

28.10		2.00s
30.10		3.30s

READ The body of the reel cuts well — a 1.0–1.4s rhythm from 13.8s to 25.7s that is genuinely close to the benchmark. The problem is at both ends. The reel opens on a 4.57s static talking head and closes on a 3.30s static card with no audio at all. **23.6% of the runtime sits in four shots that do nothing.** The two best shots in the file get 1.27s each.

Colour: the grade is uncontrolled

Mean frame luminance across the sixteen shots swings from **96** to **201**. Red-minus-blue skew — a proxy for warmth — swings from **+25** to **+80**. Cutting from a dim, green-cast talking head under a ceiling light into a blown cream product macro reads to a viewer as *two different videos*, not two shots.

SHOT	CONTENT	MEAN LUMA	R - B SKEW	READS AS
01	Hook, talking head	114	+37	dim, tungsten
03	Box in hand	150	+33	bright, neutral
05	Ring on hand	113	+52	dim, very warm
09	Hoops in box	173	+40	blown
11	Bracelet macro	137	+56	orange cast
15	Sign off	96	+38	darkest in reel
16	End card	201	+80	coral, +105 luma jump

The last cut is the worst: shot 15 at luma 96 straight into an end card at luma 201. That is a **+105 point jump in one frame**, into silence. It reads as the video breaking.

5.4 / 10

Ten dimensions, weighted by what actually moves a cold-traffic jewellery ad. Scored against 2026 benchmarks, not against taste.

Hook — first 3 seconds		4.0
Script & argument		5.5
Offer & price clarity		3.0
Footage & coverage		6.0
Edit & pacing		5.5
Sound design		2.0
Typography & graphics		5.0
Platform hygiene		4.0
Fidelity to your own BRAND.md		4.0
Claims & compliance		3.5

DIMENSION	WEIGHT	SCORE	THE ONE SENTENCE THAT EXPLAINS IT
Hook	18%	4.0	Positive-discovery family, 3.9s long, no visual change for 4.57s, wrong price anchored.
Script	15%	5.5	Real voice and correct craft vocabulary, but a list with no argument and no CTA in the VO.
Offer clarity	12%	3.0	Price-led hook; no price ever on screen; no COD; no shipping; no returns.
Footage	12%	6.0	Bracelet macros and the henna are genuinely strong; the hero ring is never in macro.
Edit	12%	5.5	Good 1.0–1.4s body rhythm bracketed by a 4.57s opener and a 3.30s dead tail.
Sound	10%	2.0	Zero music, zero foley, 2.9s of literal digital silence. VO itself is clean.
Typography	8%	5.0	Two type systems fighting; cards centred in scrim boxes over the subject.
Platform hygiene	6%	4.0	Loudness is fine. Safe zones are not. 33.4s is outside the 15–30s band.
Brand fidelity	4%	4.0	Breaks four explicit rules in your own BRAND.md, including the anti-discount position.
Compliance	3%	3.5	No ASCI disclosure label; “WATERPROOF” end card contradicts your own FAQ.
Weighted total	100%	5.4	A competent draft with an uncompetitive first three seconds.

Where the ceiling is

5.4 → 7.6	7.6 → 8.8	8.8 → 9.4
-----------	-----------	-----------

Re-edit only. No reshoot, no Riya, no new VO. Sixteen of the twenty craft defects are timeline work. Roughly four hours. See \$10.

Re-edit + new VO on the same picture. Rewrite to the objection-first structure, re-record, re-cut to 26s. One day.

The VO reel. A purpose-shot proof reel — macro, water demo, scale reference, foley recorded live. Half a day of shooting. See \$8.

WHAT A 10 WOULD REQUIRE, HONESTLY

Nothing in this format reaches ten on the first attempt, and you should be suspicious of anyone who says otherwise. The published winner rate for accounts under \$10K/month is **3.8%** — about **24 creatives tested before one lands**. That number is already in your own BRAND.md. A “10” is not a video you make; it is the one out of twenty-four that the auction tells you is a 10. What this document can do is make sure all twenty-four are built on the right structure, so the hit rate is 3.8% of good ideas rather than 3.8% of guesses.

TWENTY-THREE, RANKED BY COST

Ranked by expected cost to performance, not by how annoying they are. **RE-EDIT** = fixable on the existing timeline. **REWRITE** = needs new VO. **RESHOOT** = needs the camera back out.

STRATEGIC — THE THREE THAT DECIDE THE RESULT

#	DEFECT	EVIDENCE & CONSEQUENCE	FIX
S1	Wrong hook family for cold traffic	"Nobody told us...would look like this" is positive-discovery. Across 52 DTC accounts, objection-first hooks ran 15–25% lower CAC and direct-contradiction 25–40% lower than benefit-led on cold prospecting. At ₹3,000/day you are almost entirely cold.	REWRITE
S2	Anchored at ₹2,500; hero is ₹1,199	The Cushion Halo Ring is ₹1,199. The hook names the ceiling instead. The strongest number you own is never spoken or shown.	REWRITE
S3	No proof beat at all	Of ~1,500 active Indian jewellery ads pulled from Meta Ad Library on 17 Sep 2026, only two ran an objection-first headline and one a durability-mechanism hook. Durability is the one claim you can physically demonstrate and the category answers it with adjectives. This reel answers it with a spoken sentence at 25.8s.	RESHOOT

SCRIPT & STRUCTURE

#	DEFECT	EVIDENCE & CONSEQUENCE	FIX
01	Hook payload lands at 2.4s; first cut at 4.57s	Reels autoplay means frame one carries the decision; guidance is a first cut inside 3s and never a talking head over 8s without a visual change.	RE-EDIT
02	5.0s spent on "a brand you haven't heard of yet"	15% of runtime on brand ego. Worse: for a ₹2,500 unbranded purchase, "you haven't heard of us" is a reason to hesitate, not to buy — unless it is immediately paid off with proof. It isn't.	REWRITE
03	It is a list, not an argument	Three SKUs, one line each. No product gets enough weight to be wanted; no claim gets a reason-to-believe. The structures that convert cold are objection → agitate → demo → payoff → CTA.	REWRITE
04	Best line buried at 25.8s	"Two years plating guarantee" is the only objection-killer in the script. It is spoken once, never shown, and arrives at 77% runtime — past where most of the audience has gone.	RE-EDIT
05	No CTA in the voiceover, anywhere	Mid-video CTAs placed between 20–50% of runtime out-perform end-only CTAs. This reel has no spoken CTA at all; the only ask is a silent card.	REWRITE
06	No price, no COD, no shipping, no returns on screen	COD is 30–60% of Indian D2C orders and naming it aloud is among the highest-leverage lines available. You also have ₹150 insured shipping, 7-day returns, 3–5 day delivery and 4.9★ from 50+ reviews on every hero SKU — not one of these appears.	RE-EDIT
07	"Keep it between us" suppresses sharing	A charming line that instructs the viewer to do the opposite of the thing that makes a Reel cheap.	REWRITE
08	33.4s is outside the performance band	15–30s is the Meta sweet spot; the 15–30s band carries the highest median CTR (~1.6–1.7%). You are 11% over the ceiling, and 3.3s of the overage is a dead card.	RE-EDIT

SOUND

#	DEFECT	EVIDENCE & CONSEQUENCE	FIX
09	2.9s of true digital silence at the tail	Measured $-inf$ dBFS from 30.5s to 33.4s — not quiet, <i>zero samples</i> . Over a static card. In a looping format this is a guaranteed swipe and it breaks the loop.	RE-EDIT
10	No music bed at all	Campaigns carrying music or voiceover show materially higher incremental conversions. This has voice but no bed, so every inter-phrase gap is -47 dB of mic hiss.	RE-EDIT
11	No foley on a jewellery ad	A box lid, a clasp, a tennis bracelet articulating — all on screen, none audible. A single sound cue landed on the exact frame of a product reveal is reported to lift completion more than changing the entire music track.	RESHOOT

EDIT, GRADE & GRAPHICS

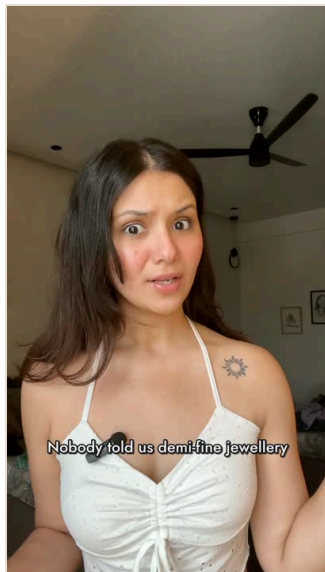
#	DEFECT	EVIDENCE & CONSEQUENCE	FIX
12	Captions at 21% bottom clearance	Lowest caption pixel measured at y=1512 of 1920 . Conservative paid-Reels reserve is ~ 500 px (nothing below y=1420); your BRAND.md says 40%. Every caption is partly under the username block and the Shop Now button.	RE-EDIT
13	Shot weighting is inverted	The two longest shots (4.57s, 4.60s) are the two least interesting. The bracelet macro — the best frame in the file — gets 1.27s.	RE-EDIT
14	Grade uncontrolled: luma 96–201, R–B +25 to +80	Shot 15 (luma 96) cuts straight to the end card (luma 201): a +105 jump in one frame . Reads as the video breaking.	RE-EDIT
15	Hero ring never shot in macro	The VO says “four-claw setting” over a hand at arm’s length where the ring is ~ 40 px wide. The claim and the picture never meet. At macro, depth of field is millimetres — this needs a tripod and AE/AF lock, not a held hand.	RESHOOT
16	Time-to-product 4.6s; time-to-jewellery 8.2s	A quarter of the ad passes before the viewer sees what is for sale. Target is product in frame by 0.8–1.5s and legible by 3s.	RE-EDIT
17	Two type systems fighting	Bold stroked sans captions and delicate Vellista serif cards, on screen simultaneously, both centred, competing for the same eye on a 1080-wide frame.	RE-EDIT
18	Name cards are centred scrim boxes over the subject	Breaks three explicit BRAND.md rules at once: never centred, left-aligned ragged right, and “ <i>darken that background region — never add a scrim box.</i> ” They also carry no price.	RE-EDIT

EDIT, GRADE & GRAPHICS — CONTINUED

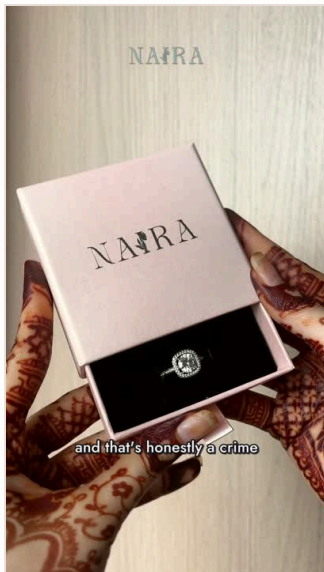
#	DEFECT	EVIDENCE & CONSEQUENCE	FIX
19	Ceiling fan in the top third of every talking-head shot	In 9:16 the top third is the most valuable real estate you own, because it is the part Instagram’s chrome does not cover. It currently holds a fan.	RESHOOT
20	Brand bug measured at 1.21:1 contrast	Functionally invisible. Separately, the current evidence argues against a persistent bug at all: unwatermarked UGC reads as content rather than advertising. Either make it read or remove it — and the recommendation is remove it.	RE-EDIT
21	Static flat-colour end card, 3.3s	Guidance is 1.5–2.5s <i>over live product footage</i> , not a flat slab; minor motion on CTA elements is reported to lift tap-through 8–14% over fully static.	RE-EDIT

22	No scale reference anywhere	42% of shoppers judge size from the image alone (your BRAND.md). Nothing in 33 seconds tells a viewer how big the ring, the hoops or the bracelet actually are. This is the single largest driver of jewellery returns.	RESHOOT
23	1.10x global speed ramp applied to macros too	Speeding a macro makes gold read as jittery and strips the premium cue. Apply ramps to VO segments only, never to product macros.	RE-EDIT

WHAT THE FRAMES SHOW



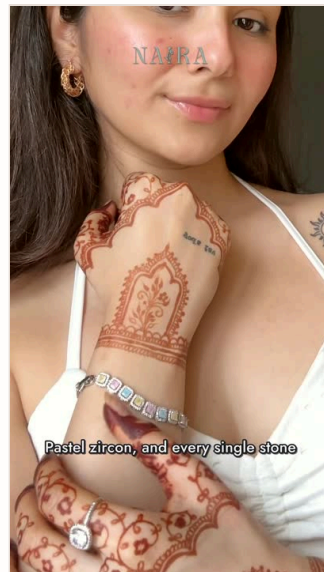
0:00.6 — the hook. Nothing changes here for 4.57s. Ceiling and fan occupy the top third. The product is not in frame. Caption sits at $y \approx 1470$.



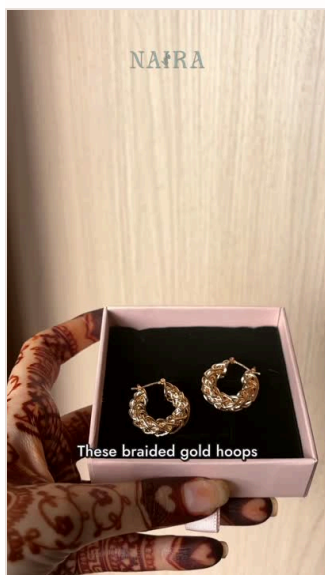
0:08.2 — first jewellery. 8.2 seconds in. The box shot is well lit and the henna is doing real work here, unbidden.



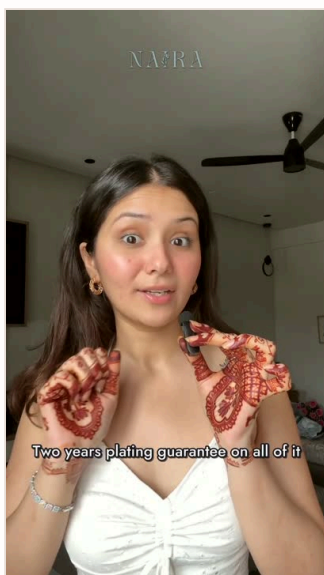
0:11.5 — the hero. The VO says "four-claw setting". The ring is ~ 40 px wide and out of the focal plane. Name card centred over the subject in a scrim box.



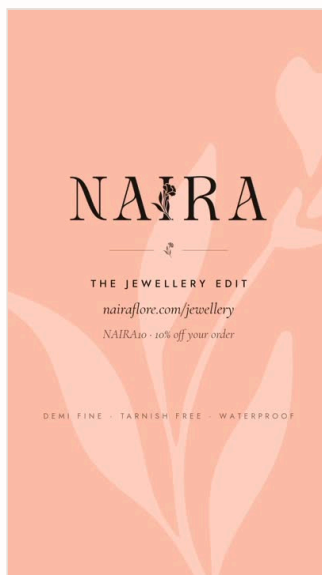
0:22.4 — the best frame in the file. Close, on skin, in focus, henna in context. It holds for 1.27 seconds.



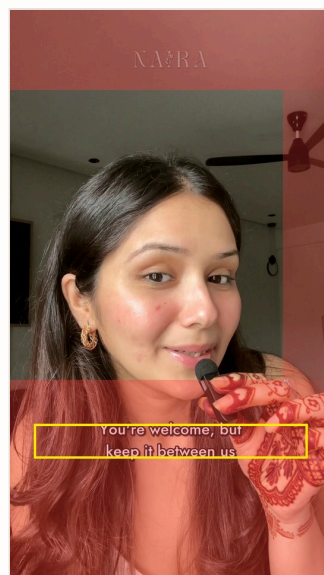
0:16.0 — the hoops. Worn shot, but no scale reference and the grade jumps ~ 60 luma points from the shot before it.



0:27.0 — the strongest claim. "Two years plating guarantee" is spoken here and never appears as a graphic. It is substantiated on your PDPs — but not on the page the ad links to.



0:31.5 — the end card. Flat colour, static, $-\text{inf dB}$ for 2.9s. Also carries "WATERPROOF", which your own FAQ does not support.



Safe-zone overlay. Red = reserved by Instagram chrome on a paid Reel. Yellow = where your captions actually sit. They are inside the reserve for the whole ad.

SAFE ZONES — THE MEASUREMENT

Meta publishes no pixel table, and the third-party reverse-engineerings disagree by up to 270px on the bottom reserve. The conservative union of four sources, applied to a *paid* Reel (which reserves extra space for the Sponsored label and the CTA button that an organic post does not):

EDGE	RESERVE	RULE ON A 1080×1920 CANVAS	THIS REEL
Top	260 px	Nothing load-bearing above $y=260$	bug at $y=35$ x

Bottom	500 px	Nothing below $y=1420$	captions to $y=1512$ x
Right	150 px	Clear $x=930 \rightarrow 1080$ below $y \approx 600$	clear ✓
Left	60 px	—	clear ✓
Caption band	—	Baseline centred $y = 1150-1330$	$y = 1396-1512$ x
Hook card	—	$y = 400-700$, above the caption band	not used

Moving every caption up 200px is a thirty-minute job and it is the highest return-per-minute fix in this entire document. Build the four rectangles as a guide layer and preview on a real phone before export — the zones shift with app updates.

FIX THESE BEFORE SPEND, NOT AFTER

Four findings. Two are genuine exposure. I have checked each claim in the reel against your own live product pages.

VERIFIED — THE CLAIM HOLDS

"TWO YEARS PLATING GUARANTEE ON ALL OF IT" — SUPPORTED

Every hero PDP carries "2-year plating assurance" alongside "7-day returns" and "₹150 insured shipping". The claim is substantiated. **But it is not on /jewellery, which is where the ad sends people.** Your single strongest line is missing from the landing page it drives to. Put the assurance badge in the collection header.

EXPOSURE — ACT ON THESE

1 · THE END CARD SAYS WATERPROOF. YOUR FAQ DOES NOT.

Your own site: "It is waterproof-sealed for incidental contact such as rain or washing hands. Remove pieces before swimming, as chlorine and salt water degrade any plated finish over time." The end card's flat **WATERPROOF** is a broader claim than the page it links to. Established guidance for this category in India is to write **water-resistant**, or the demonstrable and much stronger "**rain, washing up, monsoon — it stays on**", unless you hold a test result. Also note your BRAND.md territory two currently reads "Shower in it. Swim in it." — "**swim in it**" **directly contradicts your FAQ and should be struck from the territory list.**

2 · NO ASCI DISCLOSURE LABEL ANYWHERE IN 33.4 SECONDS

If Riya was paid or gifted — barter counts — ASCI's influencer guidelines require a disclosure label (**#Ad**, **#Sponsored** or **#Collaboration**) visible above the fold. For a video of this length the requirement is **visible for one-third of the runtime — about 11 seconds here**. There is none, and the advertiser carries the liability, not the creator. ASCI processed 1,409 influencer violations through Nov 2025; **94% were disclosure failures** — it is overwhelmingly the thing that gets caught.

Fix: burn **#Ad** into the *top third* of the frame (not the bottom — Reels chrome covers it) from 0:00, and hold it 11s. Tag the ad as branded content in Meta.

3 · DRIP-PRICING RISK WHEN YOU START NAMING A PRICE

The CCPA *Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023* name thirteen patterns; **drip pricing** is quoting a figure the checkout then exceeds. You charge **₹150 insured shipping**. The moment the VO says "₹1,199", say what it lands at — "**₹1,199 plus ₹150 insured delivery**" or "**₹1,349 delivered**". This costs you nothing and removes the exposure entirely. Penalties under the Consumer Protection Act 2019 run to ₹50 lakh and endorsement bans up to three years.

Also: **never write "18K gold" — always "18K gold-plated"**. BIS hallmarking has been mandatory for 14K/18K/22K gold since 2021 (9K added July 2025) and applies to solid gold only. Your Woven Gold Hoops PDP currently lists Finish

as 18k gold. That is a wording fix on the site, and a hard rule for every script. Note too that the **Cushion Halo Ring is rhodium-finished, not gold** — no script may call it gold.

4 · REVIEWS APPEAR TO BE POOLED ACROSS SKUS

The Cushion Halo Ring PDP shows a 4.9★ review describing “*the blush cluster ring*”; the Woven Gold Hoops PDP shows one describing “*the pastel zircon bracelet*”. If reviews are shared across products, that is a misleading-review risk under the same CCPA guidelines, and it will read as fake to any viewer who clicks through from an ad that just told them to trust an unknown brand. Worth correcting before you spend behind trust-led creative.

META POLICY TRAPS TO KEEP OUT OF EVERY FUTURE SCRIPT

- **No outcome guarantees.** “Never tarnishes”, “lasts forever”. Write “*316L steel core — it won’t rust*” or “*worn daily for 60 days*”, both substantiable.
- **No personal attributes.** “*If your skin turns green*” is fine. “*If you have sensitive skin*” is a rejection.
- **No named competitors.** “*vs the ₹18,000 one*” is safe; “*the [Brand] dupe*” is not.
- **No false urgency.** Your BRAND.md already says this. Five units per SKU is real scarcity and a genuine asset — but only state it when it is true on the day.
- **Turn off Advantage+ creative enhancements** at ad level — specifically *Music* and *Image animation*. Meta enables these by default and will lay an unbriefed music bed over your VO and warp product edges.

THE UNRESOLVED STRATEGIC CONTRADICTION — YOUR CALL, NOT MINE

Your BRAND.md, built from 498 live competitor creatives, concludes: “*Discounting is not the entry fee... the brand that carries an offer in 0% of copy holds the best median impression rank of six, and the one that discounts in 80% ranks second worst.*”

The live site is **100% discount-led**: every SKU carries a struck-through MRP (32–62% off), and a scrolling bar repeats **10% OFF YOUR FIRST ORDER · USE CODE NAIRA10**. The ad’s end card doubles down with the same code. Whatever the merits, **the research you commissioned and the store you built are arguing opposite positions**, and the creative is currently following the store.

My recommendation, which lets you have both: **run price-led on cold, code-led on retargeting**. On cold traffic say the real number — “*₹1,199, COD available*” — because a real price is a claim about value and a percentage is a claim about desperation. Save NAIRA10 for people who already know you. Of the ~1,500 active Indian jewellery ads pulled, near-every one is a discount or a price ladder. Being the one that isn’t is the cheapest differentiation available to you.

WHAT THE FIRST THREE SECONDS HAVE TO DO

Hooks are not decoration on the front of a script. On cold traffic they are most of the result, and they are the only element you can swap without reshooting anything.

The benchmark you are being measured against

METRIC	BROKEN	BASELINE	GOOD	EXCELLENT
Hook rate (3s plays ÷ impressions) — Reels	<15%	25–30%	30–35%	35–45%
Hook rate — cold prospecting (median ~22%)	<15%	18–28%	28–32%	32%+
Hold rate (15s plays ÷ 3s plays)	<10%	15–25%	25–30%	30%+
Outbound CTR, cold, India	<0.6%	0.8–1.2%	1.2–1.5%	1.5%+

Reels runs roughly **5–8 percentage points above Feed** for the same asset, so benchmark by placement or you will kill a working creative. Note the caveat that matters most: **hook rate is a kill signal, not a pick signal**. No published research establishes a reliable relationship between thumbstop, hold rate, CTR and ROAS. Use it to stop paying for ads nobody watches — never to choose a winner. Your BRAND.md already has the right gates: hook <20% at 5k impressions → kill; outbound CTR <0.6% at 8k → kill; never kill before ~1,000 impressions or 48–72 hours.

The finding that should decide your hook mix

NEGATIVE BEATS POSITIVE ON COLD TRAFFIC, AND IT IS NOT CLOSE

Across 52 DTC accounts, measured as CAC against a benefit-led baseline on cold prospecting:

HOOK FAMILY	CAC VS BASELINE	BEST FIT
Direct contradiction — “Stop buying X”	-25 to -40%	Cold, ceiling-testing
Objection-first — “I almost didn’t order this”	-15 to -25%	Cold, considered purchase
Comment overlay — a real objection as text	-10 to -20%	Cold and warm
Problem acknowledgment	-10 to -20%	Recognised pain
Benefit-led / positive discovery — <i>your current hook</i>	baseline	Retargeting, warm

It inverts on warm audiences — at the decision stage people need reassurance, not warning — and it habituates, so cap negative framing at about **30% of the portfolio**. At ₹3,000/day you are almost entirely cold, and your current hook is sitting on the baseline row.

RECOMMENDED ALLOCATION FOR NAIRA

COLD — 60% OF SPEND	WARM & FESTIVE — 40%
---------------------	----------------------

40% objection-first / skeptic-converted
20% direct contradiction
Both carry a physical proof beat.

30% positive discovery, styling, gifting
10% pure offer — and this is the only place NAIRA10 belongs.

The gap in the market, measured

META AD LIBRARY, INDIA, ACTIVE ADS, 17 SEP 2026

Of roughly **1,500 active Indian jewellery ads** surfaced: **two** objection-first headline hooks, **one** durability-mechanism hook. Everything else is a price, an offer or a product name. GIVA is running “Enjoy UP TO 50% OFF today” across ~415 ads. Palmonas is running “PALMONAS MEGA SALE” across ~141. **Rubans** — your closest competitor — runs a line literally titled “Demi Fine 18K Gold Plated Stainless steel” across ~188 ads, alongside price-in-headline carousels from ₹768 to ₹3,341.

The two best hooks in the entire pull came from brands you have never heard of: **Iqaya Designs** — “No Green Skin. Just Gold.” and **Aurel.India** — “Jewellery You Can Actually Wear Every Day”, where the word *Actually* is doing all the objection work. Four words each, category-specific, zero discount.

Also worth copying: Palmonas is running at least one ad **through a creator’s own page** (partnership / whitelisted). That is the single most copyable tactic in the pull and it is free reach you are not using with Riya.

A spoken objection-first hook carrying a physical proof act is close to unoccupied space in Indian jewellery right now. That is the lane, and it is the same conclusion your 498-creative BRAND.md audit reached by a different road: nobody in this category argues craft.

Hooks that are burnt — do not write these

POV: YOU FOUND THE PERFECT...

STOP SCROLLING!

WAIT, YOU NEED TO SEE THIS

THIS CHANGED MY LIFE

TIKTOK MADE ME BUY IT

DAY IN MY LIFE

ANY OPEN ON PRODUCT AGAINST WHITE

Hooks fatigue faster than any other creative element. Assume a **2–4 week shelf life** and refresh on cadence, not on performance collapse. Meta’s ranker also suppresses near-duplicates, so five variants of the same sentence are one ad in the auction, not five.

FORTY LINES, WRITTEN FOR THIS CATALOGUE

Every line is a *spoken* first line under twelve words, with a matching 3–8 word overlay. Every number in them is real and checked against your live PDPs. None makes an outcome guarantee, names a competitor, uses false urgency, or addresses a personal attribute. **HINGLISH** lines keep the spec in English, where authority lives, and the emotion in Hindi, where believability lives.

OBJECTION-FIRST & SKEPTIC-CONVERTED — THE COLD WORKHORSE

01 “Every thousand-rupee ring I’ve owned went green in a month. This one is on day sixty.”

OVERLAY: DAY 60 · NO GREEN · PICTURE: EXTREME MACRO, RING ALREADY ON THE FINGER

02 “I bought this to prove it was rubbish.”

OVERLAY: I WAS WRONG · STRONGEST FOUR-SECOND SETUP IN THE BANK

03 “Sach batau? Mujhe laga ye teen din mein kaala ho jayega.”

OVERLAY: DAY 3? TRY DAY 60 · HINGLISH

04 “I’ve thrown away more jewellery than I’ve worn. Here’s the one that stayed.”

OVERLAY: THE ONE THAT STAYED

05 “Nobody gives you a warranty on plating. Naira gives you two years.”

OVERLAY: 2-YEAR PLATING ASSURANCE · SUBSTANTIATED ON EVERY PDP

06 “My last three chains turned my neck green. I kept the receipts.”

OVERLAY: THIS ONE DIDN’T

07 “Pehle main teen sau wali leti thi — aur har mahine phuk deti thi.”

OVERLAY: ₹300 → BIN · ₹1,199 → DAY 60

08 “I washed up in this. On purpose. For two months.”

OVERLAY: WASHING UP · MONSOON · STILL ON

09 “The reason your gold-plated jewellery dies isn’t the gold. It’s the base.”

OVERLAY: IT’S THE BASE · MECHANISM HOOK — NICKEL-FREE BASE IS THE PAYOFF

10 “Ask a demi-fine brand what’s under the plating. Most of them change the subject.”

OVERLAY: WHAT’S UNDERNEATH?

DIRECT CONTRADICTION — COLD, CEILING-TESTING, CAP AT 30% OF PORTFOLIO

11 “Stop buying jewellery you take off before you wash your hands.”

OVERLAY: KEEP IT ON

12 “Don’t buy this ring if you’re only going to wear it once.”

OVERLAY: BUILT FOR EVERY DAY · REVERSE PSYCHOLOGY + QUALIFIER

13 “Stop paying eighteen thousand for something you’re scared to wear.”

OVERLAY: ₹1,199 · WEAR IT ANYWAY · NO BRAND NAMED — POLICY-SAFE

14 “Gold-plated mat kharido. Jab tak ye do cheezein na pooch lo.”

OVERLAY: TWO QUESTIONS TO ASK

15 “Throw out everything that turned your skin green. Then watch this.”

OVERLAY: START AGAIN

DEMONSTRATION & DURABILITY — SHOOT THESE SILENT, LABEL WITH TEXT

16 “This has been under a running tap for four minutes.”

OVERLAY: STILL RUNNING · TAP, NOT A POOL — MATCHES YOUR FAQ EXACTLY

17 “Same ring. Day one and day sixty. Tell me which is which.”

OVERLAY: WHICH IS WHICH? · SPLIT SCREEN, NO CUT

18 “Four claws hold this stone. Not glue.”

OVERLAY: FOUR CLAWS · NOT GLUE · STRAIGHT FROM YOUR BRAND.MD TERRITORY ONE

19 “Haldi, pasina, baarish — sab jhel liya. Dekho.”

OVERLAY: IT SURVIVED THE WEDDING

20 “Anti-tarnish sealed over a nickel-free base. That’s the whole trick.”

OVERLAY: NICKEL-FREE BASE · MECHANISM, VERBATIM FROM YOUR FAQ

21 “Watch the light move through it. That’s a brilliant cut, not a bead.”

OVERLAY: BRILLIANT-CUT ZIRCON · CRAFT LANE — NOBODY IN CATEGORY CLAIMS THIS

PRICE ANCHOR — SAY THE NUMBER, NEVER BADGE THE DISCOUNT

22 “Guess what this ring costs. You will be wrong.”

OVERLAY: ₹1,199 · REVEAL AT 0:08, NOT 0:02

23 “Everything on this hand is under two and a half thousand rupees.”

OVERLAY: ALL OF IT · TRUE: ₹1,199 + ₹1,799 + ₹2,499

24 “Eleven ninety-nine. Plus a hundred and fifty, delivered and insured.”

OVERLAY: ₹1,349 DELIVERED · DRIP-PRICING-SAFE BY CONSTRUCTION

25 “Three pieces. Under six thousand. Cash on delivery.”

OVERLAY: COD AVAILABLE · COD IS 30–60% OF INDIAN D2C ORDERS

26 “I stopped spending six thousand a time on jewellery. Here’s what I do now.”

OVERLAY: THE SWAP

27 “Under two thousand, and it doesn’t look under two thousand.”

OVERLAY: ₹1,799 · FOR THE WOVEN GOLD HOOPS

SOCIAL-PROOF INTERCEPTION

28 “Four people asked me where this is from. In one day.”

OVERLAY: FOUR. IN ONE DAY. · ONLY IF TRUE — IT MUST BE REAL

29 “Meri maa ne poocha — ‘beta, ye asli hai kya?’ ”

OVERLAY: SHE ASKED IF IT WAS REAL · HIGHEST-BELIEVABILITY LINE IN THE BANK

30 “Fifty-one people have reviewed this ring. It’s sitting at four point nine.”

OVERLAY: 4.9★ · 51 REVIEWS · VERIFY THE COUNT ON THE DAY YOU SHIP THE AD

31 “My colleague thought this was my wedding jewellery.”

OVERLAY: IT’S ₹2,499

32 “This bracelet is the one people stop me for.”

OVERLAY: PRISM RIVIÈRE · YOUR EXISTING LINE — IT IS GOOD, IT IS JUST IN THE WRONG POSITION

SIZE & SCALE — THE RETURNS-KILLER NOBODY IS USING

33 “Everyone gets the size wrong online. This is exactly how big it is.”

OVERLAY: ACTUAL SIZE · RING BESIDE A ₹10 COIN, SAME FOCAL PLANE

34 “Hoops always look huge in photos. Here they are on a real ear.”

OVERLAY: REAL EAR · REAL SIZE

35 “We make US five, six and seven. Six ships today.”

OVERLAY: US 6 IN STOCK · HONEST, AND IT PRE-EMPTS THE SIZING OBJECTION

INSIDER, GIFTING & OCCASION — WARM AND FESTIVE

36 “Nobody’s heard of this brand yet. Give it six months.”

OVERLAY: BEFORE EVERYONE ELSE · YOUR CURRENT BEAT TWO, COMPRESSED TO NINE WORDS

37 “Behen ko kya du — har saal yahi sawaal.”

OVERLAY: UNDER ₹2,000 · SHIPS IN 3 DAYS

38 “A gift she’ll still be wearing after the festival is over.”

OVERLAY: THAT’S THE POINT

39 “One ring. Three ways. Same fifty rupees a month.”

OVERLAY: ₹1,199 ÷ 2 YEARS · REFRAMES PRICE AS COST-PER-WEAR

40 “Seven-day returns. Insured delivery. You genuinely cannot lose here.”

OVERLAY: 7-DAY RETURNS · RISK-REVERSAL CLOSE — STRONG AS A HOOK AND AS A CTA

HOW TO USE THIS BANK

Lines **01–21** carry the majority of cold spend — that is where both the CAC data and the category gap point. Lines **22–27** are your price-led cold set; run them *without* a discount badge. Lines **28–40** are warm, retargeting and festive.

Do not write forty scripts. **Write one body and forty first lines.** A voiceover reel lets you swap the opening three seconds without touching the creator, the picture or the grade — which is the single biggest budget efficiency available at ₹3,000/day. Four hooks against one body, everything else held constant, 5–7 days of data, then test CTAs against the winner.

"DAY SIXTY" — THE BUILD

Why voiceover is the right format for Naira, specifically

A talking head sells **credibility** — the face is the proof, so the script has to be a claim about the speaker. A voiceover sells **the product** — the picture is the proof, so the script is a claim about the object and the voice narrates what the eye is already seeing. Four reasons that matters here:

1. **Your unclaimed lane is craft, and craft has to be seen.** Nobody in this category argues setting, cut or finishing. You cannot argue it over a face at arm's length. You argue it in macro.
2. **VO reels tolerate faster cutting** — roughly a cut every 1.5–2.5s, because there is no lip-sync to respect. Talking head needs a b-roll insert every 4–6s just to avoid the mid-roll dead zone.
3. **You can swap the hook without the creator.** Write one body and five first lines and one shoot becomes five ads. At ₹3,000/day this is the single biggest efficiency available to you.
4. **It removes the ceiling fan.** No room, no background, no lighting continuity problem — one window, one surface, one hand.

THE CONCEPT

Objection-first, proof-led, price-honest. Open on the objection every Indian buyer of ₹1,000 jewellery already holds — *it will go green* — then spend the middle of the reel physically disproving it, and close on a real number rather than a percentage. This is the hook family with the lowest measured CAC on cold traffic, in the one angle where you have physical proof and the category has only adjectives.

VO-1 — "Day Sixty" · 27 seconds · primary cold creative

52 SPOKEN WORDS

2.67 WORDS/SEC

~19.5S SPEECH

~8S PICTURE & FOLEY

HERO: CUSHION HALO RING ₹1,199

0.0-0.4	<i>[no voice]</i> PICTURE · Cold open. Extreme macro, ring already on the finger, a water bead rolling off the stone. Slight handheld drift. Motion in the first frame — never a static open, never a fade up. ON SCREEN · #AD (TOP THIRD, HOLDS 9S)
0.4-2.1	"Green finger. Every time." PICTURE · Hold the macro. The payload word lands at 0.9s. ON SCREEN · GREEN FINGER. EVERY TIME.
2.1-2.5	<i>[0.4s breath — let the overlay land]</i> PICTURE · Hard cut to the ring off the hand, on a plain surface, ₹10 coin beside it in the same focal plane. Scale, established at 2.1s.

2.5–5.4	“That’s every thousand-rupee ring I’ve owned.” PICTURE · Two cuts across this line — the coin shot, then a drawer of dead, discoloured jewellery. The evidence of the problem. ON SCREEN · ALL OF THEM
5.4–7.6	“This one’s on day sixty.” PICTURE · Cut back to the ring worn, on the hand, in daylight. Music downbeat lands here. ON SCREEN · DAY 60
7.6–10.6	“Washing up, monsoon, two weddings.” PICTURE · Three shots, ~1.0s each, cut on the word. Hands in a sink. Rain on a windowsill, ring in frame. The hand in a mehndi/wedding context — use the henna.
10.6–13.8	“Rhodium over a nickel-free base. Anti-tarnish sealed.” PICTURE · Macro on the band, rotating slowly. One large soft key, one small hard specular kicker — without the kicker metal renders matte. ON SCREEN · NICKEL-FREE BASE · ANTI-TARNISH SEALED
13.8–16.6	<i>[no voice — music ducks out, foley up]</i> PICTURE · THE PROOF. One unbroken take, no cut. Ring on the finger, under a running tap, four full seconds, then out, shaken once, held to camera still wet. Shoot at 60fps. The cut is what would destroy this — if there is an edit between the water and the reveal, the proof is worthless. ON SCREEN · NO CUTS. ONE TAKE.
16.6–19.2	“Four claws hold the stone. Not glue.” PICTURE · Tightest macro in the reel. The four prongs visibly gripping the girdle, tool marks left in. Tripod, AE/AF locked, subject slid into the focal plane — phones cannot rack focus. ON SCREEN · FOUR CLAWS · NOT GLUE
19.2–21.8	“Two years on the plating. Seven-day returns.” PICTURE · Hand turning, ring catching light. Two spec chips cut in on the beat, 1.4s hold each, no bounce. ON SCREEN · 2-YEAR PLATING ASSURANCE 7-DAY RETURNS
21.8–24.6	“Eleven ninety-nine. Thirteen forty-nine delivered.” PICTURE · Worn shot, whole hand, natural light. The price chip sits <i>next to the product in frame</i> — never in a corner; corner chips read as banner ads. ON SCREEN · ₹1,199 · ₹1,349 DELIVERED · COD
24.6–25.9	“Tap Shop Now.” PICTURE · Never “link in bio” — a paid Reel has a real button and “link in bio” trains the viewer to leave the ad unit. ON SCREEN · ↓ SHOP NOW
25.9–27.0	<i>[music resolves on the downbeat — never silence]</i> PICTURE · End card over live product footage, not a flat colour. 1.1s. Logo, one line, price-from. Small motion on the CTA element. ON SCREEN · NAIRA PETITE · NAIRAFLORE.COM/JEWELLERY

NON-NEGOTIABLES BEFORE YOU SHOOT THIS

“Day sixty” must be true. Put a ring on someone on a dated day, photograph it that day, and shoot the reel sixty days later. If the number is invented the whole reel is a lie and the one angle you own becomes the one that gets you reported. The same applies to “two weddings” and to any review count you quote.

The water demo is a tap, not a pool. Your FAQ says incidental contact — rain, washing hands — and says remove before swimming. A tap take is fully supported and reads exactly as convincingly. Do not shoot a pool.

ONE SHOOT, ELEVEN ADS

The body of VO-1 (5.4s–27.0s) never changes. Only the first 5.4 seconds and the opening b-roll do. That is the whole testing programme.

FIVE HOOK SWAPS AGAINST THE SAME BODY

LABEL	SPOKEN 0.4–5.4S	OPENING PICTURE	FAMILY
HOOK-GREEN	"Green finger. Every time. That's every thousand-rupee ring I've owned."	Macro, water bead → drawer of dead jewellery	Objection
HOOK-PROVE	"I bought this to prove it was rubbish. Sixty days later I'm still wearing it."	Ring held between two fingers, turning	Skeptic
HOOK-TAP	[silent 2s of the tap running] "Four minutes under a tap. Watch what doesn't happen."	Cold open on the proof act itself	Demo
HOOK-GUESS	"Guess what this ring costs. You'll be wrong."	Macro, stone rotating, no price yet	Price anchor
HOOK-MAA	"Meri maa ne poocha — 'beta, ye asli hai kya?' "	Worn shot, hand lifting to the light	Social proof

SISTER CUTS FROM THE SAME RUSHES

15S COMPRESSION

Hook + proof + price + CTA.
Drop the problem beat and the spec beat. For Stories, for retargeting, and as the length test.

ASMR-LITE, NO VO

Box lid, tissue, clasp, chain pour, the tap. Text cards only. Sound-off safe by construction, and the cheapest variant to make.

STATIC / CAROUSEL SIBLING

For jewellery, statics outperformed video on CTR in a 12-month account teardown (~4%+ at ~\$0.25 CPC vs Reels ~3.4%).
Build one per concept.

Portfolio target is roughly **55–65% static, 35–45% video**. One shoot → 5 hooks × 2 lengths + ASMR cut = **11 video assets**, plus the statics. Tag every clip at ingest by action ("tap take", "claw macro", "coin scale", "box open") so anyone can assemble without re-watching rushes.

VO-2 — "Guess" · 22s · price-anchor, cold, no discount

0.0–2.4	"Guess what this ring costs." PICTURE · Extreme macro, stone rotating, light moving through the cut. ON SCREEN · GUESS.
2.4–5.0	"Brilliant-cut zircon. Four claws. Rhodium finish." PICTURE · Three macros, ~0.9s each, cut on the noun. ON SCREEN · BRILLIANT-CUT · FOUR CLAWS · RHODIUM
5.0–8.0	"Two-year plating assurance. Seven-day returns. Insured delivery."

	PICTURE · Worn on the hand, natural light, slow push in.
8.0–9.2	<i>[0.6s silence — music drops to nothing]</i> PICTURE · Hold on the ring, absolutely still. The only deliberate pause in the reel.
9.2–11.8	“Eleven hundred and ninety-nine rupees.” PICTURE · Music returns hard on “eleven”. Price chip cuts in beside the ring. ON SCREEN · ₹1,199
11.8–15.0	“Thirteen forty-nine delivered. Cash on delivery if you want it.” PICTURE · Scale shot — ring beside a ₹10 coin. ON SCREEN · ₹1,349 DELIVERED · COD AVAILABLE
15.0–18.6	“Same hand: hoops, seventeen ninety-nine. Bracelet, twenty-four ninety-nine.” PICTURE · Pull wide to the whole hand and wrist — the range shot, and the AOV move. ON SCREEN · ₹1,799 · ₹2,499
18.6–20.6	“All of it under two and a half thousand. Tap Shop Now.” ON SCREEN · ↓ SHOP NOW
20.6–22.0	<i>[music resolves]</i> PICTURE · End card over the live worn shot.

VO-3 — “She Asked If It Was Real” · 24s · social proof, warm & festive

0.0–2.8	“Meri maa ne poocha — ‘beta, ye asli hai kya?’ ” PICTURE · Worn shot, hand lifting into window light, henna visible. ON SCREEN · SHE ASKED IF IT WAS REAL
2.8–5.4	“It’s not. It’s better than it has any right to be.” PICTURE · Macro on the stone, light travelling through the cut.
5.4–9.0	“Brilliant-cut zircon, four claws, a rhodium finish that hasn’t dulled.” PICTURE · Three macros on the beat. This is the craft beat — hold it. ON SCREEN · FOUR CLAWS · NOT GLUE
9.0–12.6	“Fifty-one people have reviewed it. It’s sitting at four point nine.” PICTURE · Cut to the wrist — the Prism Rivière articulating as the hand turns. Foley: the bracelet. ON SCREEN · 4.9★ · 51 REVIEWS (verify on ship date)
12.6–16.2	“Anti-tarnish sealed, nickel-free, two years on the plating.” PICTURE · The tap take, shortened — still unbroken. ON SCREEN · 2-YEAR PLATING ASSURANCE
16.2–19.8	“Ring’s eleven ninety-nine. Hoops seventeen ninety-nine. Both ship in three days.”

	ON SCREEN · ₹1,199 · ₹1,799 · SHIPS IN 3–5 DAYS
19.8– 22.4	“Seven-day returns, insured both ways. Tap Shop Now.” PICTURE · Risk reversal, then the ask. ON SCREEN · ↓ SHOP NOW
22.4– 24.0	<i>[music resolves]</i> PICTURE · End card over live footage.

HALF A DAY, ONE WINDOW, A PHONE

Twenty-two setups. Shoot every one at 60fps so you keep the option of slow motion. Clean the piece with a microfibre cloth before *every* setup — at macro, one fingerprint is the whole shot.

#	SHOT	HOW	SERVES
A1	Extreme macro, ring on finger, water bead rolling off the stone	Tripod. Macro mode. Tap to focus, then press-and-hold for AE/AF lock . Window key, white bounce card opposite.	Hook / cold open
A2	Ring beside a ₹10 coin, same focal plane	Flat plain surface, shot slightly down. The coin is the scale referent.	Scale — the returns killer
A3	Drawer / dish of dead, discoloured jewellery	Handheld, top-down, slight drift. This is the problem, made physical.	Problem beat
A4	Ring worn, whole hand, daylight	Tripod. Eyeline / hand on the upper third ($y \approx 640$) so the lower frame stays free for captions.	Payoff
A5	Hands washing up, ring on	Real sink, real suds. Record live sound.	Durability
A6	Rain on a windowsill, hand in frame	Any wet day. Do not fake it with a spray bottle if you can wait.	Durability
A7	Henna hand, wedding context	The most ownable frame you have. A competitor sourcing the same factory cannot copy this.	On Indian skin
A8	Macro on the band, rotating slowly	Two lights: one large soft key, one small hard specular kicker. Without the kicker, metal renders as matte plastic.	Material
A9	THE TAP TAKE — one unbroken shot, 6–8 seconds	Ring on the finger → under a running tap, hold four full seconds → out → shake once → hold to camera, still wet. No cut anywhere. Record the water live. Shoot five takes.	The proof
A10	Tightest macro in the reel: four prongs gripping the girdle	Tripod, locked focus, slide the ring into the focal plane — phones cannot rack focus, and DOF here is millimetres.	Craft proof
A11	Hand turning, ring catching light	Handheld with slight drift — movement is what makes metal live.	Spec chips
A12	Wrist, Prism Rivi�re articulating as the hand turns	Record the articulation sound live. This is your best existing footage; reshoot it better.	Range / AOV
A13	Hoops on a real ear, profile, hair tucked back	Include the ear as its own scale referent.	Scale
A14	Whole hand + wrist, all three pieces	The range shot. Drives multi-unit and the ₹1,800–2,400 AOV.	AOV
A15	Box closed in hand → lid lifted → piece revealed	One take. Tape peel → lid → tissue → reveal, in that order.	Unboxing / ASMR cut
A16	Clasp closing, macro	Silent room, phone 10cm away.	Foley + hardware

A17	Chain pouring onto a hard surface	The single best jewellery sound there is.	Foley
A18	Day-one piece beside day-sixty piece	Split frame, one shot, no cut. Only shoot this if you genuinely have both.	Proof
A19	Putting the ring on, ordinary morning	One take, doing something else — hair tie, tea, phone.	Everyday cue
A20	Piece against a collarbone	Body reference — second scale channel.	Scale
A21	Plain-surface product bed for end-card underlay	Slow drift, 4s. This replaces the flat coral slab.	End card
A22	Five hook performances, straight to camera, tripod	Only if you want a talking-head sibling. Eye level or slightly above, subject 1—1.5m, light behind the phone. Plain wall — no fan.	Hook swaps

SHOOTING RULES THAT DECIDE WHETHER THIS WORKS

- **Shoot the talking head on a tripod and the product macros handheld.** Stability reads as credibility on a face; drift reads as life on metal. The opposite arrangement is exactly what makes UGC look fake.
- **One window, both setups.** If the macros are in 5600K daylight and the face is under a 3200K bulb, no grade will match them without costing you gold accuracy. Shoot both in the same light.
- **Set a custom white balance from a grey card in that light and use the same value on every shot.** A small warm subject often has no true neutral in frame, so auto-WB guesses differently shot to shot — that is precisely what produced the +25 to +80 skew spread in the current reel.
- **Never the built-in flash.** If adding light, use CRI ≥95 LEDs — cheap LEDs put a green-yellow spike into gold that no grade fully removes.
- **9:16 exaggerates horizontal movement.** A pan that reads smooth in 16:9 is nauseating vertical. Keep lateral motion minimal or use a gimbal.
- **Twenty minutes of foley is the highest-value recording on the shoot (A15–A17).** No library SFX will match your actual box and your actual clasp.

THE SHEET TO BUILD AGAINST

Hand this page to whoever cuts it. Every number here is a decision already made.

DELIVERY

CONTAINER	MP4, H.264
RESOLUTION	1080 × 1920 (9:16)
FRAME RATE	shoot 60 · deliver 30 or 60
AUDIO	AAC 128 kbps, 48 kHz
LENGTH — PRIMARY	22-28 s
LENGTH — SISTER	15 s
FILE SIZE	keep under 1 GB

PACING

MEAN SHOT — HOOK/BODY	1.8 - 2.6 s
PRODUCT HERO HOLDS	3.5 - 5.0 s
FIRST CUT	inside 3.0 s
VISUAL CHANGE EVERY	3 - 5 s
TALKING HEAD MAX	8 s without a change
CUTS IN A 27S REEL	12 - 16
CEILING	>25 cuts / 30s = clip-farm
PRODUCT IN FRAME BY	0.8 - 1.5 s
PRODUCT LEGIBLE BY	3.0 s
DEAD AIR	cut anything ≥1 s
BREATHING ROOM	keep ~0.3 s, never clip a syllable
SPEED RAMP	1.05-1.12× on VO only, pitch-preserved. Never on a macro.

CAPTIONS

SIZE	68 - 76 px (hook 96-130)
WEIGHT	700 - 900
FACE	one geometric sans, one weight
COLOUR	white + 3-5 px dark stroke
SHADOW	y 2-4 px, 30-40%, blur 8-12
BOX	never — boxes read as tool-default
CONTRAST	≥4.5:1 against real pixels
LINES	max 2 · ≤32 chars/line
BLOCK	3-5 words, one accent word
MOTION	hard cut-in. No per-word wobble.
BAND	y = 1150 - 1330, fixed
TIMING	0.1-0.3 s ahead of the word, min 1.5 s on screen

SAFE ZONES — PAID REEL

TOP RESERVE	260 px
BOTTOM RESERVE	500 px — nothing below y=1420
RIGHT RESERVE	150 px below y≈600
LEFT	60 px
HOOK CARD	y = 400 - 700
#AD LABEL	top third, from 0:00

SOUND

INTEGRATED LOUDNESS	-14 LUFS
TRUE PEAK	-1.0 dBTP
VO CHAIN	HPF 70-80 Hz → denoise → EQ → comp → de-ess → limiter
COMPRESSION	3:1, atk 5-10 ms, rel 60-100 ms, 4-6 dB GR
DE-ESSER	narrow 5-8 kHz, very fast atk/rel
MUSIC BPM	85 - 105, no vocal
DUCKING	12-16 dB, atk 20 ms, rel 400 ms
BED UNDER SPEECH	-26 to -30 dBFS
BED IN GAPS	-16 to -18 dBFS
FOLEY LEVEL	-18 to -22 dBFS
FOLEY DUCK	extra 3-6 dB for 300 ms
SILENCE	never — music resolves under the end card

MUSIC LICENSING — THIS WILL GET THE AD REJECTED

You cannot use Instagram's trending-audio library in a paid ad. The moment a Reel is boosted or built as an ad, Meta fingerprints the audio against the *commercial* licensing database. Unlicensed audio means a rejected boost and a copyright flag; repeated flags reportedly restrict audio on all your ads.

Use: Meta Sound Collection (cleared, but *Meta platforms only*) or an **Epidemic Sound / Artist** subscription if the asset also has to run on YouTube or your site.

And turn off Advantage+ "Music" and "Image animation" at ad level. Meta enables these by default and will lay an unbriefed bed over your VO.

GRADE — CORRECT, DON'T STYLE

1. Neutralise every shot to the same white-balance reference first.
2. Match exposure **on the skin**, not on the background. Then match black level.
3. Only then apply one very light shared look. Trim it per shot — never treat a LUT as set-and-forget.
4. **Gold:** pull saturation out of the *orange* range specifically while holding *yellow*; lift the highlight roll-off so speculars go to near-white rather than clipping orange. Brassy gold is the first tell of cheap jewellery imagery.
5. **Indian skin:** sits slightly *below* the standard skin-tone line on the vectorscope. Grade to that, not to the printed line. Most LUTs are built for lighter Western skin and will push it pink or grey. Grade shadows, mids and highlights separately — never a global warm push, which turns already red-yellow skin orange fast.
6. **Ceiling:** WB + exposure + a gentle contrast S + selective orange desaturation + a skin qualifier. **No film emulation, no halation, no heavy vignette, no teal shadows.** Over-polish costs you the format's entire advantage.
7. **Target:** shot-to-shot mean luminance within **±15** and R-B skew within **±8**. The current reel is at ±52 and ±27.

GRAPHICS

- **Name card:** top third (y 400–650), **left-aligned ragged right**, 1.5–2.5s hold. If the ground behind it fails contrast, **darken that region — never add a scrim box**. That is your own rule and it is the right one.
- **Price chip:** adjacent to the product in frame, never in a corner. 1.2–2.0s. Quiet — thin rule, brand type, the ₹ figure. No starburst, no red, no percentage. At demi-fine prices a discount-bin badge actively damages the category cue.
- **Never three text objects at once.** Caption + name card + chip on one 1080-wide frame is the mistake the current reel makes.

- **Motion:** hard cut-in on a VO beat or a foley hit. If animating, 6–8 frames of y-translate + opacity. **No scale-bounce, no spring easing** — that is the CapCut-default tell.
- **No persistent brand bug.** Unwatermarked UGC reads as content, not advertising. Brand through the packaging in the unboxing shot, one spoken mention, and the end card. If a bug is politically required: $\leq 40\text{px}$, 40% opacity, top-left at $x=60$ $y=300$, and only from halfway through.
- **End card:** 1.5–2.5s **over live product footage**, never a flat colour slab. Minor motion on the CTA element. Music resolves — never cut to silence.

5.4 → 7.6 WITH THE FOOTAGE YOU ALREADY HAVE

No reshoot. No Riya. No new voiceover. Four hours on the existing timeline, in this order — the list is sorted by return per minute of work.

	DO THIS	TIME	WHY IT PAYS
01	Move every caption up 200px to a fixed band at y=1150–1330.	30 min	Takes every line of the ad out from under Instagram's chrome. Highest return per minute in the document.
02	Kill the silence. Lay a licensed 85–105 BPM bed with no vocal across the whole reel. Duck 12–16 dB under the VO. Resolve it on the end card.	45 min	Removes 2.9s of true digital silence and –47 dB of hiss in every gap.
03	Cut the opening shot from 4.57s to ~2.0s. Push in 8% on the retained portion so there is motion, and hard-cut to the first product frame at ~2.0s.	20 min	Brings the first cut inside 3s and time-to-product from 4.6s to 2.0s.
04	Cut the end card from 3.30s to 1.5s and lay it over the box footage (shot 3) instead of the flat coral.	20 min	Removes the dead slab; brings total runtime to ~29s, inside the band.
05	Add a price chip at 11.5s: ₹1,199 beside the ring, quiet, 1.6s hold. And a second at 21s for the bracelet.	25 min	Puts the strongest number you own on screen for the first time.
06	Promote the guarantee. Build a spec chip — 2-YEAR PLATING ASSURANCE • 7-DAY RETURNS — and place it at 13.8s , at the 46% mark, not at 25.8s.	20 min	Moves the only objection-killer in the ad from the tail to the middle, where people still are.
07	Re-weight the shots. Extend the bracelet macro (21.8s) from 1.27s to ~2.6s by holding on the still frame. Trim the 4.60s ring shot to ~2.4s.	30 min	Gives your best footage the time it deserves and takes it from your worst.
08	Match the grade. Neutralise all 16 shots to one WB, match exposure on skin, then a single light look. Target ±15 luma.	50 min	Removes the “different video” feeling, especially the +105 jump into the end card.
09	Move the product name cards to the top third, left-aligned, and replace the scrim box with a darkened background region.	30 min	Stops three text objects competing, and brings the reel back inside your own BRAND.md.
10	Add foley from library or a quick phone record: box lid at 7.2s, a clasp at 15.1s, bracelet articulation at 21.8s. –18 to –22 dBFS.	30 min	Three sounds. The product-reveal sync cue is reported to move completion more than the entire music track.
11	Burn in #Ad in the top third from 0:00, holding ~10s.	10 min	Closes the ASCI exposure. Ten minutes.
12	Change “WATERPROOF” on the end card to WATER-RESISTANT or RAIN • WASHING UP • MONSOON .	5 min	Brings the card in line with your own FAQ.
13	Remove the brand bug (currently 1.21:1 — invisible anyway).	5 min	Unwatermarked reads as content. You lose nothing you currently have.
14	Un-ramp the macros. Remove the 1.10x from the three product macro shots; keep it on the talking head.	15 min	Stops the gold reading jittery.

Total

~5.5 hrs

Estimated 5.4 → 7.6. Nothing here needs a camera.

AND ONE MORE, IF YOU WILL RE-RECORD THE VOICE

Everything above leaves the existing VO in place, so the reel stays in the positive-discovery hook family — the baseline row of the CAC table. Re-recording only the **first two lines** to an objection-first opening, over the same picture, is perhaps ninety minutes more work and is worth more than items 03 through 14 combined. Suggested, cut to the existing 0–9.2s:

“Green finger. Every time. That’s every thousand-rupee ring I’ve owned... so I bought this one to prove it was rubbish.”

HOW TO SPEND ₹3,000 A DAY

The arithmetic you are working inside

3.8%

Winner rate for accounts under \$10K/month. **~24 creatives tested before one lands.** From your own BRAND.md.

10–14 DAYS

How long UGC holds efficiency before CTR/CVR decline 25–40%. Studio creative holds 18–25. Refresh on cadence, not on collapse.

₹50–90

Indian Meta CPM, up ~23% YoY. At ₹3,000/day that is roughly 35–60k impressions daily — enough to read a hook in 2–3 days.

Round one — hook swap

Four hooks against **one** body and **one** CTA. Everything else held constant. Change one element per variant or you learn nothing. Let it run **5–7 days**. Then round two tests CTAs against the winning hook.

CELL	HOOK	FAMILY	HYPOTHESIS
A	HOOK-GREEN	Objection-first	The CAC data's favourite. Expected best cold performer.
B	HOOK-TAP	Demonstration	Cold open on the proof act. Should win hook rate outright; may lose CTR.
C	HOOK-GUESS	Price anchor	Tests whether a real number beats an objection in this category.
D	Current reel, re-edited	Positive discovery	The control. Without it you cannot prove any of this worked.

Kill gates — in this order, and never before 1,000 impressions or 48–72h

GATE	THRESHOLD	ACTION
Hook rate @ 5,000 impressions	<20%	Kill. The first three seconds are wrong.
Outbound CTR @ 8,000 impressions	<0.6%	Kill. Cold CTR below 0.8% is a creative problem, not an audience problem.
Hold rate (15s ÷ 3s)	<10%	The body is wrong, not the hook. Keep the hook, rebuild the middle.
ATC @ 300 landing-page views	<3%	Offer or page problem, not creative. Look at /jewellery, not the reel.
Purchases at 3x target CPA	zero	Kill.

Use hook rate to kill, never to pick. No published research establishes a reliable link between thumbstop, hold rate, CTR and ROAS. An ad can hold a 45% hook rate and sell nothing.

Naming — use this and Motion will group your hooks for you

NAIRA_<shoot>_<concept>_<hookLabel>_<len>_<ratio>_v<N>

NAIRA_SEP26_V0-DAY60_H00K-GREEN_27s_9x16_v1
NAIRA_SEP26_V0-DAY60_H00K-TAP_15s_9x16_v2a
NAIRA_SEP26_UGC-RIYA_H00K-CONTROL_29s_9x16_v1

Keep the hook label **identical** in the ad name, the file name and the UTM. That is the only way to answer “which hook works” three months from now.

Five things to fix off the reel

1. **Put the 2-year plating assurance on /jewellery.** It is on every PDP and missing from the page the ad lands on. Your strongest claim currently disappears on click.
2. **De-pool the reviews.** The Cushion Halo Ring page shows a review describing a “blush cluster ring”. An ad built on trust cannot land on a page that reads as fabricated.
3. **Fix the Finish field on the Woven Gold Hoops** from 18k gold to 18K gold-plated.
4. **Decide the discount question.** Price-led on cold, code-led on retargeting, is the recommendation. Right now the store argues one position and the research you commissioned argues the other.
5. **Whitelist the creator’s page.** Palmonas is already running ads through a creator’s own handle. It is free reach and it is the most copyable thing in the whole competitive pull.

MEASUREMENTS, FACTS & SOURCES

Product facts used, verified against live PDPs on 17 Sep 2026

PIECE	PRICE	MRP	FINISH	SIZE	RATING
Cushion Halo Ring	₹1,199	₹2,399	Rhodium · brilliant-cut zircon · 4-prong	US 5/6/7 — 6 in stock	4.9★ (51)
Woven Gold Hoops	₹1,799	₹2,769	18K gold finish · polished metal	One size, adjustable	4.9★ (50)
Prism Rivière Bracelet	₹2,499	₹3,689	Rhodium · brilliant-cut zircon	One size, adjustable	4.9★ (51)

All three carry: **2-year plating assurance · 7-day returns · ₹150 insured shipping · delivery 3–5 working days**, dispatched from the Mumbai atelier. Site-wide: **NAIRA10**, 10% off first order. Note the site meta describes the brand as “crafted in Nashik” while PDPs say *Mumbai atelier* — worth reconciling before either appears in a script.

How the reel was measured

Shot boundaries — ffmpeg scene detection, threshold 0.25, 16 boundaries recovered
 Loudness — ffmpeg ebur128, integrated / LRA / true peak
 Silence — silencedetect at -30 dB, 0.25s floor; confirmed by astats RMS over the tail window
 Transcript — Whisper (small), word-level timestamps, 88 words recovered
 Grade — per-shot midpoint frame, mean channel values and Rec.709 luminance
 Caption position — per-frame scan for white-adjacent-to-black stroke signature, rows 900–1920
 Contrast — WCAG relative-luminance ratio, ink vs ground, per text block
 Catalogue — live fetch of nairaflore.com collection and product pages, 17 Sep 2026

What is evidence and what is craft opinion

Two figures in this document carry real statistical weight: **Motion’s Creative Benchmarks 2026** (578,750 creatives, 6,015 advertiser accounts, \$1.29bn of Meta spend, Sep 2025–Jan 2026) and the **WCAG 2.2 contrast thresholds**. The **52-account CAC comparison** behind the negative-hook recommendation is the best decision-grade evidence found for hook family. Everything else — caption-style lifts, foley lifts, end-card lifts, speed-ramp effects — is vendor-reported without published methodology and should be treated as a craft heuristic, not a fact. I have not dressed those up as certainties.

Three things are worth knowing are *not* established:

- **Meta publishes no safe-zone pixel table.** Every number in \$5 and \$10 is a conservative union of four third-party reverse-engineerings that disagree by up to 270px. **Preview on a real phone before launch.**
- **Meta publishes no LUFS target.** -14 LUFS / -1 dBTP is inferred industry consensus. What is confirmed is that Meta uses xHE-AAC with dynamic loudness management, and that phone speakers have almost no response below 200 Hz — so mid-range clarity at 1–4 kHz matters more than any LUFS figure. Mix so the VO is intelligible on a phone speaker at half volume in a noisy room.
- **“85% watch without sound”** is a 2016 publisher self-report, never confirmed by Meta, with no credible 2025–26 replacement. The operating rule holds regardless: **every claim in the voiceover must also exist as a caption or a graphic**, and the proof demo must be self-evident with the sound off. Treat sound as upside, never as load-bearing.

Primary sources

Meta Ad Library (India, ACTIVE, 17 Sep 2026) · motionapp.com/library/research/creative-benchmarks-2026 · sweatpantsagency.com/blog/best-ad-hooks-for-social-media · sepia-lab.com/en/blog/hook-rate-benchmarks · adlibrary.com/posts/hook-rate · adlibrary.com/posts/meta-ad-creative-best-practices · itshco.com/blog/jewelry-ad-teardown · taylorsicard.com/blog/meta-ads-creative-benchmarks-2026 · w3.org/TR/WCAG22 · firstpier.com/resources/instagram-ad-safe-zones · pod2reels.com/blog/instagram-reels-safe-zone-guide · opus.pro/blog/facebook-reels-caption-subtitle-best-practices · sovrn.ai/blog/hook-body-cta-video-ad-structure · sovrn.ai/blog/direct-response-video-ad-endings · foximusic.com/blog/instagram-reels-music-copyright-legal-guide · cloudcovermusic.com/music-licensing-guide/facebook-sound-collection · sparkugc.com/resources/advantage-plus-creative-best-practices-2026 · zellahq.com/blog/music-ducking-explained · openclip.app/learn/audio-ducking · danmurtagh.com/lufs-loudness-standards · socialmediatoday.com (Meta audio encoding for Reels) · mondoolfi.com/photographing-gold-jewellery-colour-accuracy · gemfind.com/blogs/digital-marketing/jewelry-product-photography-tips · indianfilminstitute.org (colour grading for Indian skin tones) · sandmarc.com/blogs/iphone-photography · toneproduction.net/shooting-vertical-video-framing-9-16 · insense.pro/blog/creative-testing · influee.co/blog/raw-ugc-to-ads · apogee.ad/en/blog/nomenclature-meta-ads-guide · benly.ai/learn/meta-ads/meta-ads-specs-size-guide · ascionline.in (Influencer Advertising Guidelines + 2025 disclosure report) · CCPA Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023 · ykgglobal.com/blog/bis-hallmarking-for-18k-gold · foreplay.co (Dara Denney on unicorn creative) · digiday.com/media/silent-world-facebook-video · nairaflore.com (collection and product pages)

THE ONE-LINE VERSION

The script already knows the right thing to say — it argues craft in a category where nobody argues craft. It just never shows you the craft, never says the price, and gives its best line away at second twenty-six. **Move the captions, kill the silence, cut the first shot in half, put ₹1,199 on screen, and open on the objection instead of the discovery.** That is the whole document.